

Growing up

Young octopuses continue to grow until they mate, at three to five years old. A fully grown female giant Pacific octopus is strong enough to move up to 700 lb (320 kg) using all eight arms. This is about the weight of a small pig.

See also

Explore other life in the watery world of coral (72–73).



Octopuses feed on crabs and other sea creatures.



Hatching out

After the eggs hatch, baby octopuses float up to the surface of the water. Here, they become part of the plankton (tiny living organisms that float in water). They live there for a few months before swimming to the bottom of the ocean.

Mimic octopus This is the only sea creature that can copy, or mimic, different kinds of animals, including poisonous ones like sea snakes. It does this by changing its color, shape, and texture.



Coconut octopus Also called the veined octopus, this animal can walk on two of its arms, using the other six to carry a clam or coconut shell, which it uses as a mobile home.



Argonaut octopus Instead of laying her eggs in a den or cave, this female secretes, or produces, a shell-like egg case to protect her eggs and then lives in it.

